

CHINA STAPLES

Value Retailers: Busy Ming/Wanchen officially reiterated commitment to healthy competitive environment; Store open acceleration in May; Buy

Busy Ming/Wanchen gained 9%/6% WTD, recovering part of the May 27–29 pullback of 15%/10%, which reflects easing investor concerns around increased franchisee subsidies (mainly for new store openings) in our view. On June 2, Busy Ming/Wanchen each **issued a statement via their official channel** post market close, **which formally reaffirmed their commitment to health development and rational competition**. In their respective statements, Busy Ming and Wanchen reiterated their opposition to irrational competition and expressed confidence in the substantial long-term growth runway for F&B value retailers across the broader snacks and beverages market, while emphasizing an orderly, healthy competitive environment that echos the nationwide anti-involution policy direction. **This is broadly in line with our channel checks that suggest this round of subsidy increases remains disciplined** and with our view that the market remains spacious enough for leading players to continue expanding under a still-benign competitive backdrop.

Our monthly tracker and check also indicated: **1) Acceleration in store open run rate** in 2Q25 to date for both players, with new units opened over 3,000 in 5M26 (Exhibit 1) respectively; **2) Still solid per store GMV trend**, with positive average daily GMV for Wanchen in May (incl. newly opened stores) (Exhibit 2). We expect solid 1H26/2Q26 results driven by strong store opening momentum and margin expansion from scale/efficiency for both players.

We reiterate Buy on Busy Ming/Wanchen given attractive risk/reward. After the rebound this week to date, the stocks are trading at 17x/14x 2026E P/E, respectively. **Key catalysts include: 1)** Busy Ming's HSCI inclusion, announced on May 22 (which is a prerequisite for the Southbound Stock Connect on 8 June); **2)** improving per-store GMV trends, supported by category expansion; **3)** Wanchen's update on HK dual listing schedule.

The authors would like to thank Lily Qi for her contribution to this report.

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Exhibit 1: Value retailer monthly store opening table (this data may have time/lagging difference vs the actual number)

Store number monthly tracker	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26
Busy Ming	14,737	14,956	15,152	15,474	15,989	16,783	17,584	18,551	19,517	20,513	21,041	21,948	22,801	23,291	23,771	24,271	25,178
Net add	343	219	196	322	515	794	801	967	967	996	528	907	853	490	480	500	907
store open %	2.4%	1.5%	1.3%	2.1%	3.3%	5.0%	4.8%	5.5%	5.2%	5.1%	2.6%	4.3%	3.9%	2.1%	2.1%	2.1%	3.7%
Haixianglai only	12,977	13,325	13,632	14,119	14,356	15,365	15,565	15,612	16,320	16,619	16,626	17,248	17,834	18,434	18,909	19,509	20,560
Net add	1,229	348	307	487	237	1,009	200	47	708	299	7	622	586	600	475	600	1,051
store open %	10.5%	2.7%	2.3%	3.6%	1.7%	7.0%	1.3%	0.3%	4.5%	1.8%	0.0%	3.7%	3.4%	3.4%	2.6%	3.2%	5.4%

The data may have time/lagging difference vs the act. number

Source: Douyin, Wechat official accounts, GeoQ, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Avg GMV per store summary (GSe)

Store performance: avg GMV per store yoy	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	Jan-Feb 2026	Apr-26	May-26
Busy Ming	-MSD% yoy		Down SD% yoy	Flattish yoy	HSD% growth yoy		
Wanchen	Down mid teens%	Down mid teens%	Down SD%	MSD% decline yoy	9% yoy	Up SD%	positive average daily GMV

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Busy Ming Group

Valuation: Our 12-month target price for Busy Ming is HK\$550, based on a 23x target P/E applied to our 2027E EPS and discounted back to end-2026E, using a COE of 9.4%, referencing the average trading 2027 P/E of global value-focused retail peers including Dollar General and Dollar Tree in the US, and Ryohin Keikaku and Pan Pacific International Holdings (operates Donki) in Japan, as they are scaled, price-led operators with broad, defensible customer reach similar to Busy Ming.

Key risks: 1) Intensifying competition and price investment; 2) Network density and cannibalization; 3) Franchise model risk and scaling complexity; 4) Supply chain, food safety, and logistics.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Fujian Wanchen Good

Valuation: Our 12m TP is Rmb319, based on a target 2027E P/E at 21.5x discounted back to end-2026E at an 8.2 % COE. The target P/E is at a HSD% valuation discount to Busy Ming, as we reference the average gap of DLTR's NTM P/E vs. DG's in the past two years, factoring in the relatively slower network scaling momentum and less favorable UE (lower per-store GMV but profits driven by high mix of smaller brands/white labels).

Key risks: 1) intensifying market competition and price sustainability; 2) franchise model risk and scaling complexity; 3) M&A risks; 4) supply chain, food safety and logistics.

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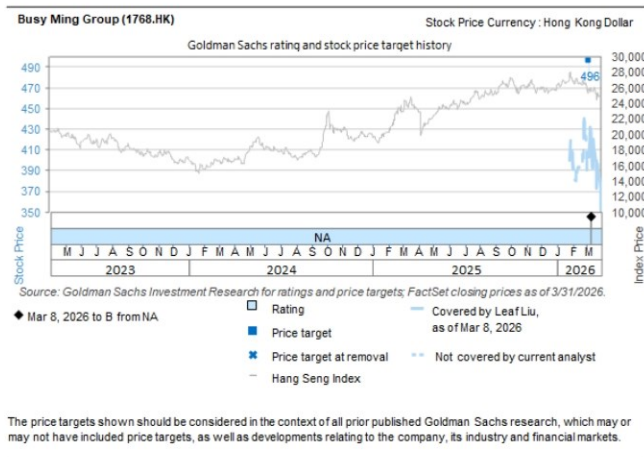
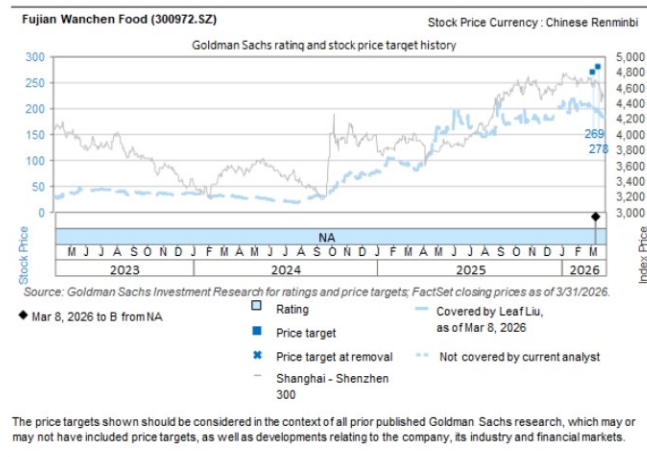
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Target price history table(s)

Fujian Wanchen Food (300972.SZ)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
28-Apr-26	319.00	203.81
17-Mar-26	278.00	192.10
08-Mar-26	269.00	201.81

Busy Ming Group (1768.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
01-Apr-26	550.00	362.60
08-Mar-26	496.00	403.20

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